Freedom of Information Team
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Our ref: FOI/2526/429

Name: Aryan Thanki
By email to: aryanthanki19@gmail.com

9 July 2026

Dear Aryan,

We received your request on 2 June. We handled this under the Freedom of Information Act (FOIA). With apologies for the delay, our response is provided below. The questions you asked are in *italics.* Our reply is in **bold**.

The University has a statutory duty to provide student and staff data to the Higher Education Statistics Agency (HESA). Our licence to use HESA data states that "no HESA Data shall be published, reproduced or shared with third parties unless the HESA Services Standard Rounding Methodology … has been applied to it". We have used the following methodology to data in this response:

- **All numbers are rounded to the nearest multiple of 5**
- **Rounding is done after calculations (sums, averages, percentages, etc.).**

For students admitted in the 2020 admissions cycle who subsequently obtained a final degree classification of 2:1 or above, please provide the number of such students who held each of the following GCSE Mathematics and GCSE English Language grade combinations at the point of admission. Please provide the number, or counts, for each category, as a table or otherwise please. Also note these are cumulative counts. In addition to the data categories already requested, please also provide the ***total population count (\(N\))****. Specifically, I require the* ***total number of all students*** *admitted to the university in the 2020 admissions cycle who subsequently obtained a final degree classification of 2:1 or above in any program.This total figure is necessary to provide the baseline context for the cumulative counts requested.*

GCSE Maths + English Language	n (number)
9-9	20
8-9 or above	115
8-8 or above	360
7-8 or above	825
7-7 or above	1575
6-7 or above	2355
6-6 or above	2985
Total 2:1 or above	3760

Notes on the data

1. **3760 is the actual (rounded) number of home undergraduates admitted in 2020 who achieved a 2:1 or higher**
2. **The GCSE score proportions are calculated from a slightly smaller sample size (3537) for whom we have valid Maths and English GCSE scores on record. These proportions were then applied to our actual 3760 figure.**
3. **In a few cases the GCSE scores that we had on record were from the old (A-E) classification system. Where that was the case, we made the following assumptions on how they translate: Grade C = 5, Grade B = 6, Grade A = 7, and Grade A* = 8.**

If you are unhappy with how we dealt with this request, you can ask us to review it. You must do so within 40 working days. Please explain why you are unhappy or why you believe our decision is incorrect. Write to the Data Protection Officer at the above address or email foi@liverpool.ac.uk.

If you remain unhappy after the review, you can appeal to the Information Commissioners' Office (ICO). You must do this within six weeks of receiving the outcome of the review. You can do this via their website www.ico.org.uk/foicomplaints or write to them at Information Commissioners' Office, Wycliffe House, Water Lane, Wilmslow, SK9 5AF.

Our Privacy Notice explains what we do with the personal data you provided to us and sets out your rights.

Yours sincerely

Kirsty Rothwell

Kirsty Rothwell
Freedom of Information Officer / Data Protection Co-ordinator